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JAPAN BY RAIL



2027
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Select a 3-, 4-, and 5-star all on the same trip -The choice is yours!

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We know the best routes and connections including luxury, scenic, and overnight rail.



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OUR RAIL PARTNERS

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JAPAN



Japan, the Land of the Rising Sun, is rich in culture, history, and breathtaking landscapes. Experience it all aboard the iconic Shinkansen, where seamless high-speed rail travel connects historic shrines, scenic regions, and vibrant cities.

Shinkansen Bullet Train



Travel with English-speaking locally hosts and guides


Private airport and hotel transfers


First-class Green Car seating on Shinkansen


MATSU
Gokay
KANAZAW
Shirakawa-g
TAKAYAMA
KYOTO
Arashiyama
Himeji
OSAKA
HIROSHIMA
Miyajima


UMOTO
ama
WA
o
JAPAN
NAGANO
TOKYO
Mt. Fuji
HAKONE
Nara

TASTE OF JAPAN

TOKYO > KYOTO > OSAKA > TOKYO

Make your own sushi in Tokyo

View This Trip Online

10 DAYS | 3 DESTINATIONS




Himeji

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Rail travel as per itinerary including Shinkansen bullet train in Green Car
- 9 nights' hotel accommodation with breakfast
- Full day private sightseeing tour and sushi making class in Tokyo
- Half-day evening Izakaya tour in Tokyo
- Dinner with a geisha performance in Kyoto
- Full-day sightseeing tour of Kyoto
- Full-day sightseeing tour of Fushimi and Nara
- Full day tour and tastings in Osaka by private car and guide from Kyoto
- Full-day sightseeing tour of Himeji and Akashi
- Private transfers and escorts with an English-speaking assistant throughout

For a complete list of inclusions and up-to-date version of this itinerary, please visit our website.

OUR EXPERTS RECOMMEND

Arrive early at train stations. Japan's rail system is incredibly efficient, being a few minutes early ensures a stress-free experience.

DAY 1: YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS IN TOKYO

Welcome to Japan! Upon arrival at Narita Airport, meet your English-speaking assistant at the customs exit and transfer by private car into central Tokyo. After check-in, the rest of the day is yours to relax or start exploring. Perhaps enjoy a peaceful walk in Shinjuku Gyoen Garden or head to a nearby rooftop bar to take in views of the glittering skyline.

DAY 2: TOKYO

After breakfast, meet your English-speaking guide in the hotel lobby and set out to explore some of Tokyo's most exciting highlights. Begin with a stroll through the bustling Tsukiji Outer Market, where rows of lively stalls showcase fresh seafood, produce, and local delicacies. Take part in a hands-on sushi-making class and learn the art of preparing this iconic dish under expert instruction. In the afternoon, visit Meiji Jingu Shrine, a peaceful oasis surrounded by forest, before heading to the vibrant Harajuku Fashion Street, known for its colourful shops and unique style. After a full day discovering Tokyo's culture and flavours, return to your hotel in the evening.

DAY 3: TOKYO

Enjoy the morning at leisure—why not visit the Mori Art Museum, or do a little shopping in Omotesando? In the evening, meet your guide and head into the heart of Tokyo's nightlife for a taste of local dining culture. Stroll through the tiny alleyways of Shinjuku's Omoide Yokocho or Golden Gai, where dozens of bars and izakayas line the streets. Sample classic dishes like yakitori, sashimi, and okonomiyaki, paired with sake or a Japanese highball. This is Japan at its most atmospheric and authentic.

DAY 4: TOKYO TO KYOTO

Transfer to Tokyo Station with your assistant and board the high-speed Shinkansen for Kyoto. On arrival, meet your guide and transfer to your hotel. This evening, explore Kyoto's lantern-lit Gion district—home to wooden teahouses and the elusive geiko (Kyoto geisha). Enjoy a refined tempura dinner while being entertained by a geisha performance, a rare glimpse into this graceful tradition.

DAY 5: KYOTO

Today, your guide will lead you through the timeless treasures of Kyoto. Begin at Kinkakuji, the Golden Pavilion, with its gold-leafed reflection shimmering in the pond. Continue to Nijo Castle, once the seat of shogunate power, before admiring the thousand life-sized statues at Sanjusangendo Hall. Visit the expansive grounds of Heian Shrine and finish at Kiyomizu Temple, perched on a hillside overlooking the city. Enjoy free time in the evening to try Kyoto-style kaiseki cuisine or relax in a local onsen.

DAY 6: FUSHIMI AND NARA DAY TRIP

Your journey today blends sacred sites and local flavour. Begin at Fushimi Inari Shrine, famous for its thousands of red torii gates stretching into the forested hills. Visit a local sake brewery in the Fushimi district and sample Japan's most beloved drink. In the afternoon, continue to Nara, Japan's first capital. See the Great Buddha at Todaiji Temple, meet the friendly deer in Nara Park, and explore the serene Kasuga Taisha Shrine.



A local expert, with you every step of the way

DAY 7: KYOTO TO OSAKA

Travel by private car with your guide from your hotel in Kyoto to explore Osaka, a city bursting with energy and culinary flair. Start with panoramic views from the Floating Garden Observatory atop the Umeda Sky Building. Walk through Shinsekai or the neon-lit Dotombori district to sample takoyaki, okonomiyaki, and kushikatsu. Round off the day at the historic Osaka Castle, set in a spacious park with a moat and stone walls. Return to your hotel in the evening.

DAY 8: HIMEJI AND AKASHI DAY TRIP

Take a scenic train ride with your guide to the city of Himeji, home to Japan's most iconic feudal castle. Explore Himeji Castle, known as the "White Heron," and its defensive architecture and panoramic tower views. Stroll through Kokoen Garden, a peaceful oasis of koi ponds and teahouses. Continue to Akashi to visit the Maiko Marine Promenade, a skywalk built into the world's longest suspension bridge. Return to Osaka by evening.

DAY 9: OSAKA TO TOKYO

After a leisurely morning, meet your assistant for a private car transfer to Shin Osaka Station. Board the Shinkansen for your final journey back to Tokyo. Upon arrival, your assistant will escort you to your hotel by private car. Enjoy a final night in Japan - perhaps toast the trip with a cocktail at a sky bar or indulge in sushi at a local izakaya.

DAY 10: YOUR JOURNEY ENDS IN TOKYO

Check out of your hotel and meet your assistant for a private car transfer to Narita Airport for your flight home. If you'd like to extend your trip to another destination, your Rail Expert can help tailor your journey.

TRIP HIGHLIGHTS



Visit Tsukiji Market, Meiji Shrine, and Harajuku



Taste local favourites in an izakaya and sample sake in Fushimi



Visit Osaka's futuristic landmarks and legendary street food scene

BEAUTY OF JAPAN

TOKYO > NAGANO > KANAZAWA > KYOTO > TOKYO

Kyoto

View This Trip Online

11 DAYS | 4 DESTINATIONS





Taiko drumming class in Tokyo

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Rail travel in Green Class as per itinerary
- 10 nights' hotel accommodation with breakfast
- Full-Day Private Sightseeing Tour of Tokyo, Kamakura, Kanazawa, and Kyoto
- Full-Day Private Snow Monkey Tour
- Half-Day Private Sightseeing Tour of Arashiyama by public transport from Kyoto
- Hotel-to-Hotel luggage transfer from Kanazawa to Kyoto
- Private transfers and escorts with an English-speaking assistant throughout

For a complete list of inclusions and up-to-date version of this itinerary, please visit our website.

OUR EXPERTS RECOMMEND

Try regional cuisine along the way. From sushi in Tokyo to street food in Osaka, every destination offers its own flavors to savor.


Kanazawa

DAY 1: YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS IN TOKYO

Arrive at Narita Airport and meet your English-speaking assistant who will escort you by private car to your hotel and assist with any questions you might have. Settle into your hotel in the bustling Shinjuku district and enjoy the rest of the day at leisure to relax or start exploring Tokyo's vibrant neighbourhoods.

DAY 2: TOKYO

Join your guide for a full-day journey through Tokyo's dynamic mix of modern culture and timeless tradition. Begin with a hands-on Taiko drumming experience, then ascend Tokyo Skytree for sweeping views over the metropolis. Explore Tokyo Character Street, a haven of quirky souvenirs and themed shops, before heading to Harajuku to soak up the youthful fashion scene and buzzing street culture.

DAY 3: DAY TRIP TO KAMAKURA

Travel by public transport with your guide to the historic coastal city of Kamakura. Visit the famous Great Buddha at Kotoku-in Temple, wander the peaceful gardens of Hase Temple, and explore the sacred grounds of Tsurugaoka Hachimangu Shrine. Stroll along the lively Komachi Street, lined with traditional shops and food stalls, before returning to Tokyo in the evening.

DAY 4: TOKYO TO NAGANO

Meet your assistant for a private transfer to Tokyo Station, then board the Shinkansen for a high-speed journey through the Japanese Alps to Nagano. Upon arrival, an assistant will accompany you by public transport to your hotel. Spend the rest of the day at leisure, discovering Nagano's peaceful streets or relaxing at your hotel.

DAY 5: DAY TRIP TO JIGOKUDANI SNOW MONKEY PARK

Venture deep into the scenic mountains with your guide for a full-day visit to Jigokudani Monkey Park. Travel by express train to Yudanaka, followed by a short journey to the park where you can observe Japanese macaques soaking in natural hot springs. Surrounded by forested hills, this rare wildlife encounter offers a truly unforgettable experience. Return to Nagano in the evening.

DAY 6: NAGANO TO KANAZAWA

After breakfast, meet your assistant at the hotel for a public transport transfer to Nagano Station. Board the Shinkansen for your journey west to Kanazawa, known for its Edo-era charm and beautifully preserved districts. On arrival, walk with your assistant to your hotel and enjoy the remainder of the day at leisure.

DAY 7: KANAZAWA

Explore Kanazawa's cultural gems with your guide on a full-day tour by public transport. Begin at Kenrokuen, one of Japan's most celebrated gardens, and nearby Kanazawa Castle. Then delve into the city's samurai past at Nomura House in Nagamachi and wander the atmospheric Higashi-Chaya geisha district, known for its wooden teahouses and traditional architecture.

DAY 8: KANAZAWA TO KYOTO BY TRAIN AND HALF-DAY TOUR OF ARASHIYAMA

Begin your day by sending your main luggage ahead to Kyoto and packing an overnight bag. Travel by Shinkansen to Tsuruga, then continue to Kyoto by Limited Express Thunderbird. On arrival, enjoy a guided half-day tour of Arashiyama, visiting Tenryuji Temple, the Sagano Bamboo Grove, Togetsu Bridge, and Okouchi Sanso Villa before checking into your hotel.

TRIP HIGHLIGHTS


Ascend to panoramic heights at Tokyo Skytree


Ride the iconic Shinkansen bullet train across Japan


Walk among towering bamboo in Arashiyama

DAY 9: KYOTO

Discover Kyoto's timeless beauty with your guide on a full-day tour of the city's most iconic landmarks. Admire the golden reflection of Kinkakuji Temple, then continue to the historic grounds of Nijo Castle. Marvel at the thousand life-sized statues at Sanjusangendo Hall, walk through the vibrant grounds of Heian Shrine, and end your day at the hillside Kiyomizu Temple with sweeping views over the city.

DAY 10: KYOTO TO TOKYO

After breakfast, meet your assistant for a private car transfer to Kyoto Station and board the Shinkansen for your return to Tokyo. Upon arrival, an assistant will greet you at the platform and escort you by private car to your hotel. Spend your final evening in the capital enjoying a meal, shopping, or simply soaking up the city lights.

DAY 11: YOUR JOURNEY ENDS IN TOKYO

Check out of your hotel and transfer by private car with your assistant to Narita Airport for your return flight home.

DISCOVER JAPAN

TOKYO > HAKONE > KYOTO > OSAKA > HIROSHIMA > TOKYO

View This Trip Online

Tokyo

13 DAYS | 5 DESTINATIONS




Umeda Sky Building Floating Garden Observatory

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Rail travel as per itinerary (including Shinkansen bullet train in Green Car reserved seats)
- 12 nights' hotel accommodation with breakfast
- Full-day tours of Tokyo, Himeji, Osaka, Kyoto (Fushimi), Nara, Hiroshima and Miyajima
- Full-day tour of Mount Fuji and Hakone by private car
- Half-day Gion night tour with cultural performance by public transport
- Half-day tour of Osaka by public transport
- Private transfers and escorts with an English-speaking assistant throughout

For a complete list of inclusions and up-to-date version of this itinerary, please visit our website.

OUR EXPERTS RECOMMEND

Visit during cherry blossom or fall foliage season. Spring and autumn bring Japan's landscapes to life with unforgettable colors.

DAY 1: YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS IN TOKYO

Arrive in Japan's buzzing capital, where an English-speaking assistant will greet you at the airport and escort you by private car to your hotel. After checking in, the rest of the day is free to relax or enjoy your first impressions of Tokyo. You may choose to explore the neon-lit streets of Shinjuku, savour authentic ramen at a local eatery, or take a peaceful evening walk through a nearby garden.

DAY 2: TOKYO

Dive straight into Tokyo with a full-day guided tour by public transport. Begin with an energising Taiko drumming session, where you'll learn the rhythms of this traditional art form. Continue to the Tokyo Skytree, one of the tallest towers in the world, for sweeping city views stretching to Mount Fuji on a clear day. Explore the historic Asakusa district and its striking Sensoji Temple, then stroll along Nakamise Street, lined with shops selling traditional snacks and souvenirs. Wrap up the day amid the colourful lights and futuristic atmosphere of Akihabara, the hub of anime and gaming culture.

DAY 3: TOKYO

Join your guide again for another day of discovery in Tokyo, this time focusing on its cultural and culinary treasures. Wander through the lively Tsukiji Outer Market, where stalls brim with seafood, seasonal produce, and local delicacies. Then, take part in a hands-on sushi-making class with an expert chef and enjoy the results for lunch. Afterwards, visit the Meiji Shrine, a serene Shinto sanctuary surrounded by forest in the city's heart. End the day in Harajuku, a lively district famed for its street fashion, quirky boutiques, and youth culture.

DAY 4: DAY TRIP TO MOUNT FUJI AND TRANSFER TO HAKONE

Leave Tokyo behind for a luxury day trip to Mount Fuji and Hakone with your private driver-guide. Journey into the countryside for spectacular views of Japan's most famous peak, stopping at the Fifth Station (weather permitting). In Hakone, enjoy a scenic cruise on Lake Ashi, ride the Hakone Ropeway over volcanic valleys, and explore the Hakone Open-Air Museum, where modern sculptures stand against a dramatic mountain backdrop. After a day of natural beauty and cultural encounters, check in to your Hakone hotel for the night.

DAY 5: HAKONE TO KYOTO AND GION NIGHT TOUR

This morning, transfer to Odawara Station and board the Shinkansen for Kyoto. After checking in, enjoy free time before an evening guided walk through the lantern-lit streets of Gion, Kyoto's geisha district. Wander past traditional teahouses and atmospheric alleyways before attending a performance at Gion Corner, where you'll see traditional arts such as tea ceremony, dance, and classical music.

DAY 6: KYOTO

Discover Kyoto's historic treasures on a full-day tour by public transport. Begin at Kinkakuji, the Golden Pavilion, whose gold-leaf exterior glimmers across its reflecting pond. Continue to Nijo Castle, once home to shoguns, then explore Sanjusangendo Hall with its 1,001 statues of Kannon, the goddess of mercy. Stroll through the serene grounds of Heian Shrine, and finish with panoramic views from Kiyomizu Temple, dramatically perched above the city.

DAY 7: DAY TRIP TO FUSHIMI AND NARA

Venture beyond Kyoto with your guide for a full-day tour. At Fushimi Inari Shrine, walk through thousands of vivid red torii gates that climb into the wooded hillside. Visit a local sake brewery in Fushimi to learn about and sample Japan's iconic rice wine. In the afternoon, travel to Nara, the country's first capital, to see the Great Buddha statue at Todaiji Temple, meet the friendly deer in Nara Park, and stroll through the atmospheric Kasuga Taisha Shrine. Return to Kyoto in the evening.

DAY 8: KYOTO TO OSAKA AND OSAKA SIGHTSEEING

Take the train to Osaka and check in to your hotel before setting out with your guide for a half-day sightseeing tour. Explore Osaka Castle, a striking landmark surrounded by gardens and moats, and head to the Umeda Sky Building for skyline views from the Floating Garden Observatory. Continue to lively Dotonbori, where neon lights, theatres, and street food stalls showcase the city's vibrant character.

DAY 9: DAY TRIP TO HIMEJI AND OSAKA

Today, embark on a full-day tour with your guide, beginning in Himeji. Visit the UNESCO-listed Himeji Castle, Japan's most spectacular feudal fortress, and explore the tranquil paths and ponds of Kokoen Garden. Return to Osaka in the afternoon for further sightseeing. Stroll along the covered Shinsaibashi Shopping Arcade, discover quirky shops and eateries, or enjoy an evening sampling Osaka's world-famous street food.

DAY 10: OSAKA TO HIROSHIMA BY TRAIN

Board the Shinkansen and travel to Hiroshima. After checking in, the afternoon is yours to explore at leisure. You might wish to try the local specialty, Hiroshima-style okonomiyaki, or enjoy a riverside walk through leafy Peace Boulevard.

DAY 11: HIROSHIMA AND MIYAJIMA

Join your guide for a full-day exploration of Hiroshima and Miyajima Island. In Hiroshima, visit Peace Memorial Park, the A-Bomb Dome, and the poignant Peace Memorial Museum. Later, take the ferry to Miyajima Island, home to the iconic Itsukushima Shrine and its floating torii gate, set against forested hillsides. Explore the island's walking paths and traditional shops before returning to Hiroshima in the evening.

DAY 12: HIROSHIMA TO TOKYO BY TRAIN

This morning, board the Shinkansen for your final journey back to Tokyo. On arrival, meet your assistant for a private car transfer to your hotel. The rest of the day is free to enjoy your last evening in Japan—perhaps with last-minute shopping in Ginza or a farewell dinner overlooking the city skyline.

DAY 13: YOUR JOURNEY ENDS IN TOKYO

Check out of your hotel and meet your assistant for a private transfer to Narita Airport. Bid farewell to Japan as you board your onward flight.



Shinkansen bullet train

TRIP HIGHLIGHTS



Taste your way through Osaka's street food scene with a guided tour



Discover Kyoto's temples, gardens, and Gion's geisha district by night



Tour Nara's Todaiji Temple and meet the friendly deer in Nara Park

REFLECTIONS OF JAPAN

TOKYO > HIROSHIMA > KYOTO > OSAKA > TOKYO

Floating Torii gate of Itsukushima Shrine at Miyajima, Hiroshima

View This Trip Online

11 DAYS | 4 DESTINATIONS





Osaka

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Rail travel as per itinerary in Green Car reserved seats
- 10 nights hotel accommodation with breakfast
- Full-day tour of Tokyo with Taiko drumming experience and sushi-making class
- Full-day sightseeing tour of Hiroshima and Miyajima, Himeji, Kyoto, Osaka, and Nara
- Private transfers and escorts with English-speaking assistant throughout

For a complete list of inclusions and up-to-date version of this itinerary, please visit our website.

OUR EXPERTS RECOMMEND

Take advantage of your local host. Lean on their expertise for navigation, recommendations, and insider tips throughout your journey.



Himeji Castle

DAY 1: YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS IN TOKYO

Welcome to Japan! Upon arrival at Narita Airport, meet your English-speaking assistant who will escort you by private car to your hotel in central Tokyo. The rest of the day is yours to relax after your flight or begin exploring the city's vibrant neighbourhoods, from peaceful parks to bustling ramen bars.

DAY 2: TOKYO

Experience both ancient traditions and cutting-edge culture as you explore Tokyo with your guide. Start with a hands-on Taiko drumming session, then take in panoramic views from Tokyo Skytree. Visit the historic Sensoji Temple in Asakusa, browse the stalls of Nakamise Shopping Arcade, and wrap up the day in the electric streets of Akihabara.

DAY 3: TOKYO

Begin the day with a visit to Tsukiji Outer Market, a haven for fresh seafood and traditional street snacks. Take part in a sushi-making class led by a local chef, then continue to Meiji Shrine, nestled in a tranquil forest near the city's heart. Stroll through Harajuku's quirky fashion street before enjoying the rest of the day at leisure.

DAY 4: TOKYO TO HIROSHIMA

This morning, meet your assistant for a private car transfer to Tokyo Station, where you'll board the Shinkansen for Hiroshima. On arrival, walk with your assistant to your hotel. The afternoon is yours to unwind or explore the city's modern downtown and riverfront at your own pace.

DAY 5: DAY TRIP TO HIROSHIMA AND MIYAJIMA

Join your guide today to explore the history and spiritual beauty of Hiroshima and Miyajima. Visit Peace Memorial Park, the haunting A-Bomb Dome, and the Peace Memorial Museum. Later, travel by ferry to Miyajima Island to visit the iconic Itsukushima Shrine, famed for its floating torii gate. Return to Hiroshima by evening.

DAY 6: HIROSHIMA TO KYOTO VIA HIMEJI

Depart Hiroshima by Shinkansen and meet your guide in Himeji for a full-day tour. Explore Himeji Castle—Japan's most spectacular surviving feudal fortress—and stroll through Kokoen Garden. Visit either the Himeji City Museum of Literature or a traditional sake brewery before continuing on to Kyoto.

DAY 7: KYOTO

Uncover Kyoto's cultural treasures today with your guide. Visit the gold-leafed Kinkakuji (Golden Pavilion), explore the former shogunate seat of Nijo Castle, and walk through Sanjusangendo Hall, home to 1,001 statues. Continue to Heian Shrine and end the day with breathtaking views from Kiyomizu Temple.

DAY 8: KYOTO TO OSAKA BY PRIVATE CAR

Travel by private car to Osaka for a full-day guided tour of Japan's culinary and cultural capital. Tour Osaka Castle, take in skyline views from the Umeda Sky Building's Floating Garden Observatory, and explore the bustling shopping streets of Shinsaibashi and neon-lit Dotonbori.

DAY 9: DAY TRIP TO NARA

Explore the former capital of Nara with your guide, beginning with the Great Buddha inside Todaiji Temple. Stroll through Nara Park, where friendly deer roam freely, then visit the lantern-lined paths of Kasuga Taisha Shrine. End the day wandering the charming merchant district of Naramachi.

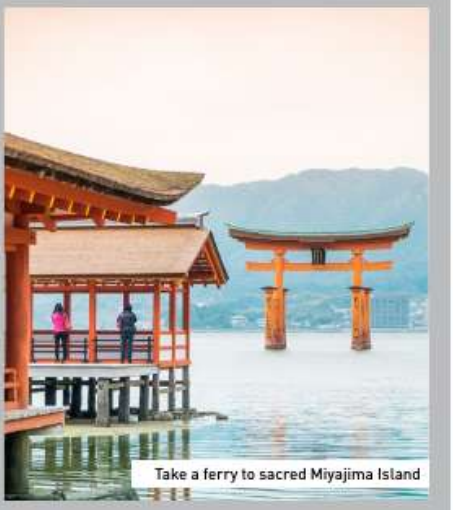
DAY 10: OSAKA TO TOKYO

After breakfast, meet your assistant for a private transfer to Shin-Osaka Station. Board the Shinkansen for your final journey back to Tokyo. Upon arrival, your assistant will escort you to your hotel, where you can spend your final evening soaking in the energy of the capital one last time.

DAY 11: YOUR JOURNEY ENDS IN TOKYO

Check out of your hotel and transfer by private car with your assistant to Narita Airport for your onward flight. If you'd like to extend your journey, just ask your Rail Expert.

TRIP HIGHLIGHTS



Take a ferry to sacred Miyajima Island



Learn Taiko drumming



See the giant Buddha at Todaiji Temple

SCENIC JAPAN

TOKYO > MATSUMOTO > TAKAYAMA > KANAZAWA > KYOTO > HAKONE > TOKYO

Explore the UNESCO-listed villages of Shirakawa-go and Gokayama

View This Trip Online

13 DAYS | 6 DESTINATIONS




Shinkansen bullet train

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Rail travel as per itinerary (including Shinkansen and limited express routes)
- 12 nights hotel accommodation with breakfast
- Sightseeing tours of Tokyo with Taiko drumming, Takayama, Kanazawa, Kyoto (Fushimi), Nara, Mount Fuji and Hakone
- Private transfer from Takayama to Kanazawa, via Shirakawa Go and Gokayama
- Paper-making experience in Gokayama
- Half-day Gion night tour with cultural performance
- Luggage transfer from Kanazawa to Kyoto
- Private transfers and escorts with an English-speaking assistant throughout

For a complete list of inclusions and up-to-date version of this itinerary, please visit our website.

OUR EXPERTS RECOMMEND

Respect local customs and etiquette. Simple gestures like quiet conversations on trains and removing shoes indoors enhance your experience and show cultural appreciation.

DAY 1: YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS IN TOKYO

Welcome to Japan! Upon arrival at the airport, meet your English-speaking assistant for a private car transfer to your hotel in Tokyo. Once checked in, the rest of the day is yours to relax or explore your surroundings. Why not take a short stroll to a local izakaya or explore the shops and cafés of nearby districts?

DAY 2: TOKYO

Discover the highlights of Tokyo on a full-day guided tour using the city's world-class public transport. Start with a hands-on Taiko drumming experience, then ascend Tokyo Skytree for sweeping skyline views. Visit the centuries-old Sensoji Temple in Asakusa and browse the traditional shops of Nakamise-dori before finishing the day in the vibrant tech and anime hub of Akihabara.

DAY 3: TOKYO TO MATSUMOTO

This morning, board the train for your scenic journey to Matsumoto, set against the backdrop of the Japanese Alps. After arriving and checking in, spend the rest of the day at leisure. You might explore the picturesque streets around Nawate and Nakamachi, or simply relax and enjoy the alpine air.

DAY 4: MATSUMOTO

Enjoy a full day to explore Matsumoto at your own pace. Visit the striking Matsumoto Castle—one of Japan's oldest original castles—and take in views of the surrounding mountains. Consider visiting the Matsumoto City Museum of Art or relaxing in a nearby onsen town such as Asama or Utsukushigahara.

DAY 5: MATSUMOTO TO TAKAYAMA BY PRIVATE TRANSFER

Travel into the heart of the Japanese Alps today with a scenic private transfer to Takayama. This traditional mountain town is known for its beautifully preserved Edo-period streets and wooden merchant houses. After checking in, enjoy the evening at leisure—perhaps with a taste of Hida beef or a stroll through the old town.

DAY 6: TAKAYAMA

Join your guide for a full-day tour of Takayama's cultural highlights. Visit the morning markets, the Takayama Jinya (historic government house), and the well-preserved old town. Learn about the area's traditional architecture and crafts, and explore museums or sake breweries along the way.

DAY 7: TAKAYAMA TO KANAZAWA VIA SHIRAKAWA-GO AND GOKAYAMA

Meet your English-speaking guide at 08:30 in the lobby of your hotel and depart by private car for a full day exploring Japan's picturesque mountain villages. Travel to the UNESCO-listed village of Shirakawago, where you'll take in sweeping countryside views from the Ogimachi Castle Ruins Observatory and step inside the historic Wada House to learn about traditional gassho-zukuri architecture and rural life. Continue onward to Gokayama to visit the preserved Nagase House and gain further insight into the region's heritage. Here, you will also enjoy a hands-on paper-making experience at Washi-no-sato or a similar workshop, discovering the craftsmanship behind this centuries-old tradition.

DAY 8: KANAZAWA

Join your guide today for a half-day introduction to Kanazawa's cultural highlights. Visit Kenrokuen Garden, regarded as one of the most beautiful landscape gardens in Japan, then stroll through the preserved Nagamachi samurai district, with its earthen walls and narrow lanes. Continue to Higashi Chaya, the city's geisha district, where wooden teahouses evoke a timeless atmosphere. After the tour, enjoy the afternoon at leisure to explore museums, markets, or sample local seafood.

DAY 9: KANAZAWA TO KYOTO

This morning, your luggage will be sent ahead to Kyoto by courier, arriving the following evening, so please prepare an overnight bag. With the help of an assistant, walk to Kanazawa Station and board the Shinkansen and Limited Express train to Kyoto in reserved Green Car seats. On arrival, meet your guide and set out on a half-day tour. Visit the historic Gion district and enjoy a traditional performance at Gion Corner before returning to your hotel for the evening.

DAY 10: DAY TRIP TO FUSHIMI AND NARA

Join your guide for a full-day journey by public transport to Fushimi and Nara. Begin at the iconic Fushimi Inari Shrine, famous for its thousands of vermilion torii gates. Continue to a local brewery for sake tasting, then travel to Nara to visit Todaiji Temple and see the friendly deer in Nara Park. Return to Kyoto in the evening.

DAY 11: KYOTO TO HAKONE

Depart Kyoto today and travel by train to Hakone, a scenic town known for hot springs and mountain views. On arrival, transfer to your accommodation and enjoy the afternoon at leisure. You may choose to relax in an onsen or explore the nearby artisan shops.

DAY 12: MOUNT FUJI AND HAKONE TO TOKYO

Enjoy a full-day private guided tour to Mount Fuji and the surrounding Hakone region. Visit the Hakone Open-Air Museum, take in stunning views of Mount Fuji (weather permitting), and explore Lake Ashi and the Hakone Ropeway. In the afternoon, continue by private transfer to Tokyo for your final night.

DAY 13: YOUR JOURNEY ENDS IN TOKYO

After breakfast, check out of your hotel and transfer to the airport for your onward journey. If you'd like to extend your trip or explore another part of Japan, your Rail Expert will be happy to help.


Mount Fuji

TRIP HIGHLIGHTS


Locally hosted guide helping you navigate each day with ease


Visit Matsumoto Castle and soak in the mountain-town charm of Takayama


Tour Kanazawa's Kenrokuen Garden and preserved samurai and geisha districts

HIGHLIGHTS OF JAPAN BY RAIL

TOKYO > OSAKA > KYOTO > TAKAYAMA > KANAZAWA > TOKYO

Shinkansen bullet train

View This Trip Online

12 DAYS | 5 DESTINATIONS




Tokyo

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Rail travel in Green Class as per itinerary
- 11 nights hotel accommodation with breakfast
- Full-day tours of Tokyo with Taiko drumming, Mount Koya, Kyoto (Fushimi) and Nara, Arashiyama, Takayama, and Shirakawa-go
- Half-day tours of Osaka, Gion night tour with cultural performance, and Kanazawa
- Private transfers and escorts with an English-speaking assistant throughout

For a complete list of inclusions and up-to-date version of this itinerary, please visit our website.

OUR EXPERTS RECOMMEND

Make the most of your trip by adding extra nights at the end to revisit favorite spots or explore more at your own pace.

DAY 1: YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS IN TOKYO

Arrive in Japan's bustling capital, where an English-speaking assistant will meet you at the airport and arrange your private transfer to your hotel. Once checked in, the rest of the day is yours to relax after your flight or begin exploring at leisure. Perhaps wander the neon streets of Shinjuku, enjoy a first taste of sushi, or take in the city lights from an observation deck.

DAY 2: TOKYO

Embark on a full-day guided tour by public transport and experience Tokyo's mix of tradition and innovation. Begin with a Taiko drumming session, an exhilarating introduction to Japanese culture. Ascend the Tokyo Skytree for sweeping views across the metropolis, then travel to Asakusa to visit Sensoji Temple and browse the historic Nakamise shopping street. End the day in Akihabara, famed for anime, manga, and vibrant pop culture.

DAY 3: TOKYO TO OSAKA AND CITY TOUR

This morning, meet your English-speaking assistant at your hotel for a private transfer to Tokyo Station. After assistance with boarding, travel in comfort onboard the Nozomi Shinkansen to Shin Osaka in your reserved Green Car seat. On arrival, your guide will meet you at the platform and accompany you to your hotel to leave your bags. Spend the afternoon exploring Osaka on a half-day tour by public transport. Discover the retro charm of Shinsekai or the lively Dotombori district, sampling local specialties such as takoyaki, before strolling along Shinsaibashi Shopping Street. Return to your hotel in the evening.

DAY 4: DAY TRIP TO MOUNT KOYA

Today's full-day excursion takes you with your guide to Mount Koya, one of Japan's most sacred destinations. Discover centuries-old temples, moss-covered cedar forests, and the atmospheric Okunoin Cemetery, where thousands of lanterns light the way to the mausoleum of Kobo Daishi, the founder of Shingon Buddhism. Learn about monastic traditions and soak in the peaceful atmosphere before returning to Osaka in the evening.

DAY 5: OSAKA TO KYOTO AND GION NIGHT TOUR

This morning, board the train for the short journey to Kyoto, Japan's former imperial capital. After settling in, enjoy some leisure time before meeting your guide in the evening. Wander the lantern-lit streets of the Gion district, where wooden teahouses line narrow lanes. Finish the evening at Gion Corner, where you'll see performances of traditional Japanese arts including dance, music, and tea ceremony.

DAY 6: DAY TRIP TO FUSHIMI AND NARA

Travel with your guide today to the famous Fushimi Inari Shrine, walking beneath thousands of bright red torii gates as they wind up the hillside. Continue to a local brewery in the Fushimi district for a sake tasting, learning how this iconic Japanese beverage is made. In the afternoon, journey to Nara to visit Todaiji Temple and its Great Buddha, before strolling through Nara Park, where tame deer roam freely. Return to Kyoto in the evening.

DAY 7: ARASHIYAMA

Spend the day exploring the beautiful Arashiyama district on the western edge of Kyoto. With your guide, visit Tenryu-ji Temple and its Zen gardens, then walk through the towering bamboo grove of Sagano, an otherworldly highlight of Kyoto. Cross the famous Togetsukyo Bridge spanning the Hozugawa River and visit Okouchi Sanso Villa, a hillside retreat with landscaped gardens and sweeping views. Enjoy the evening at leisure back in central Kyoto.

DAY 8: KYOTO TO TAKAYAMA BY TRAIN

This morning, take the scenic train journey into the Japanese Alps to reach the historic town of Takayama. After checking in, explore the town at your own pace. Stroll through the Edo-period streets lined with wooden merchant houses, stop at a local sake brewery, or sample Hida beef, a regional delicacy. The evening is yours to enjoy this peaceful mountain setting.

DAY 9: TAKAYAMA AND SHIRAKAWA-GO

Join your guide for a full-day excursion by private car to explore both Takayama and Shirakawa-go. Visit the lively morning markets and Takayama Jinya, a historic government building, before continuing to Shirakawa-go, a UNESCO World Heritage village. Marvel at the steeply thatched gassho-zukuri farmhouses, explore the open-air museum, and take in the view from the observation deck before travelling onward to Kanazawa.

DAY 10: KANAZAWA

Spend the morning exploring Kanazawa with your guide. Visit Kenrokuen Garden, considered one of the finest in Japan, and stroll through the preserved Nagamachi samurai district, where you'll find earthen walls and narrow alleys. Continue to the Higashi Chaya geisha district, known for its atmospheric teahouses. The afternoon is free for further exploration—perhaps visit Kanazawa Castle or the bustling Omicho Market.

DAY 11: KANAZAWA TO TOKYO BY TRAIN

Board the train for your return journey to Tokyo. After checking in, enjoy your final evening in Japan at leisure. You might choose to explore Shibuya Crossing, shop for souvenirs, or simply relax and reflect on your adventure with a farewell dinner.

DAY 12: YOUR JOURNEY ENDS IN TOKYO

Check out of your hotel and meet your assistant for a private transfer to Narita Airport. If you'd like to extend your journey—perhaps with more time in Tokyo or an extension to Hakone—your Rail Expert can make all the arrangements.



Osaka

TRIP HIGHLIGHTS


Feel the pulse of Tokyo through drumming, temple visits, and the city's dazzling skyline


Visit sacred Mount Koya, home to temples, monks, and atmospheric forests


Discover Kyoto's temples, gardens, and Gion's geisha district by night

THE GOLDEN ROUTE

TOKYO > HAKONE > KYOTO > TOKYO

Sacred Shika (deer) of Nara

View This Trip Online

9 DAYS | 3 DESTINATIONS





Temples of Nara

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Rail travel as per itinerary (Shinkansen Green Car reserved seats)
- 8 nights hotel accommodation with breakfast
- Full-day tour of Tokyo and a Taiko drumming lesson
- Half-day tour of Tokyo and sushi-making class
- Full-day private sightseeing tour of Mt. Fuji and Hakone
- Gion night tour and performance at Gion Corner
- Full-day tour of Kyoto
- Full-day tour to Fushimi and Nara
- Private transfers and escorts with an English-speaking assistant throughout

For a complete list of inclusions and up-to-date version of this itinerary, please visit our website.

OUR EXPERTS RECOMMEND

Pack smart and light. Traveling between cities is seamless when you keep luggage manageable and organized.



Fushimi Inari Shrine

DAY 1: YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS IN TOKYO

Arrive in the buzzing metropolis of Tokyo, where your English-speaking assistant will greet you at Narita Airport and escort you by private transfer to your hotel. Once checked in, the rest of the day is yours to unwind or begin exploring Japan's dynamic capital. You may wish to enjoy a peaceful walk through Shinjuku Gyoen National Garden or experience your first taste of Tokyo's famed culinary scene.

DAY 2: TOKYO

Step into the heart of Tokyo with your guide for a full-day discovery of its diverse districts and cultural gems. Begin with an energising Taiko drumming lesson—an immersive way to connect with Japanese tradition—then head to Tokyo Skytree, where panoramic views stretch all the way to Mount Fuji on clear days. Continue to the historic Asakusa district to visit the grand Sensoji Temple and stroll along Nakamise Shopping Arcade. End the day soaking in the bright lights and pop culture of Akihabara.

DAY 3: TOKYO

Your culinary journey begins this morning with a guided half-day tour. Start at the famous Tsukiji Outer Market, where the freshest seafood and produce draw chefs from across the city. Then, roll up your sleeves for a hands-on sushi-making class with a local expert. Continue to Meiji Shrine, a peaceful forested retreat steeped in history, before wandering the colourful streets of Harajuku, known for fashion, street food, and quirky boutiques. Enjoy the rest of the afternoon at leisure.

DAY 4: DAY TRIP TO MOUNT FUJI AND TRANSFER TO HAKONE

Leave the city behind today as you travel by private car with your guide toward Japan's most iconic natural landmark—Mount Fuji. Weather permitting, ascend to the Fifth Station for breathtaking views. Continue to the hot spring town of Hakone for a scenic boat cruise on Lake Ashi and an aerial ride on the Hakone Ropeway. Visit the Hakone Open-Air Museum, where modern art is set against a stunning mountain backdrop. Check in to your hotel for a restful night in this serene setting.

DAY 5: HAKONE TO KYOTO

After breakfast, transfer to nearby Odawara Station and board the Shinkansen for a high-speed journey to Kyoto. Upon arrival, your guide will escort you to your hotel. Later, enjoy a guided evening walk through the Gion district—Kyoto's historic geisha quarter—before attending a multi-cultural performance at Gion Corner featuring traditional arts like tea ceremony, music, and dance.

DAY 6: KYOTO

Today, experience the soul of Kyoto with your guide as you explore its most iconic landmarks. Marvel at the gold-covered Kinkakuji (Golden Pavilion), walk the corridors of Nijo Castle once home to powerful shoguns, and admire the 1,001 statues inside Sanjusangendo Hall. Visit the tranquil gardens of Heian Shrine and finish with sweeping city views from Kiyomizu Temple, dramatically perched on a hillside.

DAY 7: KYOTO - FUSHIMI AND NARA DAY TRIP

Venture outside Kyoto to discover two of Japan's most cherished destinations. Begin at Fushimi Inari Shrine, where thousands of vivid red torii gates line the mountain path. Then, visit a traditional brewery for a sake tasting experience in Fushimi—Kyoto's renowned sake district. Continue to Nara, home to the majestic Todaiji Temple and its enormous bronze Buddha. Wander through Nara Park, where tame deer roam freely, before returning to Kyoto in the evening.

DAY 8: KYOTO TO TOKYO

Enjoy a relaxed morning before transferring to Kyoto Station by private car. Board the Shinkansen and glide through the countryside back to Tokyo. On arrival, an assistant will meet you and escort you to your hotel. Spend your final evening as you wish—perhaps enjoying a last bowl of ramen, a riverside walk, or some last-minute shopping in Shibuya or Ginza.

DAY 9: YOUR JOURNEY ENDS IN TOKYO

Check out of your hotel and meet your assistant for a private car transfer to Narita Airport. If you'd like to extend your time in Japan, your Rail Expert can help tailor the perfect continuation to your journey.

TRIP HIGHLIGHTS



Learn the art of sushi-making and try your hand at Taiko drumming



Take in sweeping views from Tokyo Skytree and Mount Fuji's Fifth Station



Ride the legendary Shinkansen bullet train between Tokyo and Kyoto

THE ESSENCE OF JAPAN BY RAIL

TOKYO > HIROSHIMA > OSAKA > KYOTO > KANAZAWA > TOKYO

Arashiyama's bamboo grove

View This Trip Online

14 DAYS | 5 DESTINATIONS




Kokoen Garden

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Rail travel as per itinerary, including reserved Green Car seats on Shinkansen and Limited Express trains
- 13 nights' hotel accommodation with breakfast
- 2 Full-day private tours of Tokyo, including Taiko Drumming, and Sushi Making
- Full-day tours of Hiroshima, Miyajima, Himeji, Osaka, Arashiyama, Kyoto (Fushimi), Nara, Shirakawago & Gokayama
- Full-day tour of Kyoto by private car, including evening performance at Gion Corner
- Half-day tour of Kanazawa by public transport

For a complete list of inclusions and up-to-date version of this itinerary, please visit our website.

OUR EXPERTS RECOMMEND

Arrive a day early to adjust and explore. Adding a pre-night allows time to relax, adjust to the time zone, and ease into your journey.

DAY 1: YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS IN TOKYO

Arrive at Narita Airport and meet your English-speaking assistant after completing arrival formalities. Transfer by private car into the city and check in at your hotel. Take the remainder of the day at leisure to rest or begin exploring Japan's vibrant capital.

DAY 2: TOKYO

Meet your local guide this morning and enjoy a full-day tour of Tokyo by public transport. Begin with a hands-on taiko drum lesson before visiting the soaring Tokyo Skytree for panoramic views across the city. Continue to Asakusa, home to the famous Senso-ji Temple and Nakamise shopping street, then finish your day in lively Akihabara Electric Town.

DAY 3: TOKYO

After breakfast, set out on another full-day guided tour of Tokyo. Stroll through the bustling Tsukiji Outer Market before taking part in an interactive sushi-making class. Visit Meiji Jingu Shrine, one of Tokyo's most important spiritual sites, and round off the day with a walk through colourful Harajuku Fashion Street.

DAY 4: TOKYO TO HIROSHIMA

This morning, transfer to Tokyo Station with the help of an assistant and board the Nozomi Shinkansen to Hiroshima in your reserved Green Car seat. On arrival, meet your assistant at the station and walk to your centrally located hotel for check-in. The rest of the day is yours to relax.

DAY 5: DAY TRIP TO HIROSHIMA AND MIYAJIMA

Today, discover the moving history and natural beauty of Hiroshima and Miyajima with your local guide. Visit the Peace Memorial Park, A-Bomb Dome, and Peace Memorial Museum before travelling to Miyajima Island by ferry. Explore Itsukushima Shrine, famous for its "floating" torii gate, before returning to Hiroshima in the evening.

DAY 6: HIROSHIMA TO OSAKA VIA HIMEJI

Travel by Shinkansen this morning to Himeji, where your guide will take you on a full-day tour. Visit Himeji Castle, widely considered Japan's most beautiful fortress, stroll through the landscaped Kokoen Garden, and choose between the Himeji City Museum of Literature or a sake brewery. Continue to Osaka for your overnight stay.

DAY 7: OSAKA

Spend the morning exploring Osaka with your guide. Visit imposing Osaka Castle, admire the city views from the Floating Garden Observatory, and stroll the bustling Dotonbori and Shinsaibashi shopping streets. Return to your hotel in the afternoon for leisure time.

DAY 8: KYOTO

After breakfast, transfer with your guide by private car to Kyoto. Spend the day discovering this historic city, visiting Kinkakuji Temple (the Golden Pavilion), Nishiki Market, Nijo Castle, and Kiyomizu Temple. Stroll through Gion, Kyoto's famous geisha district, and enjoy an evening cultural performance at Gion Corner before checking into your hotel.



Meiji Jingu Shrine, Tokyo

DAY 9: DAY TRIP TO ARASHIYAMA

Explore Arashiyama on a full-day tour with your guide. Visit Tenryuji Temple and wander through the atmospheric Sagano Bamboo Grove. Cross the famous Togetsu Bridge and enjoy the landscaped gardens and views from Okouchi Sanso Villa before returning to your hotel.

DAY 10: DAY TRIP TO FUSHIMI AND NARA

Today's full-day tour takes you to the iconic red gates of Fushimi Inari Shrine and a local sake brewery for a taste of Kyoto's brewing traditions. Continue to Nara to visit Todaiji Temple, home to a giant bronze Buddha, stroll through Nara Deer Park, and admire Kasuga Taisha Shrine before returning to Kyoto.

DAY 11: KYOTO TO KANAZAWA

Your luggage will be sent ahead to Kanazawa by courier service, so please prepare an overnight bag. With your assistant, walk to Kyoto Station and board the Thunderbird Limited Express and Shinkansen to Kanazawa. On arrival, meet your guide for a half-day tour including Omicho Market, Kanazawa Castle, and the landscaped Kenrokuen Garden.

DAY 12: DAY TRIP TO SHIRAKAWAGO AND GOKAYAMA

Set out with your guide by private car for a full-day tour of the World Heritage-listed villages of Shirakawago and Gokayama. Visit the Ogimachi Castle Ruins Observatory for sweeping views, explore traditional gassho-zukuri farmhouses such as Wada and Nagase Houses, and enjoy a hands-on papermaking experience in Gokayama before returning to Kanazawa.

DAY 13: KANAZAWA TO TOKYO

Walk with your assistant to Kanazawa Station and board the Shinkansen to Tokyo in reserved Green Car seats. On arrival, transfer by private car with your assistant to your hotel. The remainder of the day is at leisure to relax or enjoy final explorations in the capital.

DAY 14: YOUR JOURNEY ENDS IN TOKYO

After breakfast, transfer by private car with your assistant to Narita Airport for your departing flight. If you'd like to extend your trip in Japan, your Rail Expert will be happy to assist.

TRIP HIGHLIGHTS



Learn Japanese culture hands-on with a taiko drumming class and sushi-making experience



Admire sweeping city views from the Tokyo Skytree, one of the tallest towers in the world



Discover Osaka with visits to Osaka Castle, Dotonbori, and the Floating Garden Observatory

THE BEST OF JAPAN

TOKYO > HIROSHIMA > OSAKA > KYOTO > TAKAYAMA > KANAZAWA > NAGANO > HAKONE > TOKYO

Jigokudani Monkey Park

View This Trip Online

18 DAYS | 8 DESTINATIONS





Shirakawago

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Rail travel as per itinerary, including the Shinkansen and Limited Express trains
- 17 nights hotel accommodation with breakfast
- 2 Full-day private tours of Tokyo, including Taiko Drumming, and Sushi Making
- Full-day private tours of Hiroshima, Miyajima, Himeji, Osaka, Kyoto, Nara, Takayama, and Kanazawa
- Private transfer from Takayama to Kanazawa
- Paper-making experience in Gokayama
- Full-day private tour of the Snow Monkeys from Nagano by public transport
- Full-day private tour of Mt. Fuji and Hakone
- Luggage transfer from Kyoto to Kanazawa
- Private transfers and escorts with an English-speaking assistant throughout

For a complete list of inclusions and up-to-date version of this itinerary, please visit our website.

OUR EXPERTS RECOMMEND

Embrace the fully planned experience. Your itinerary is thoughtfully designed to showcase Japan's highlights, relax and enjoy each moment knowing every detail has been expertly arranged.

DAY 1: YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS IN TOKYO

Arrive at Narita Airport, where an English-speaking assistant will meet you after customs for a private transfer to your hotel, where you will receive all of your travel documents and vouchers. The rest of the day is yours to relax or begin exploring Japan's vibrant capital, perhaps with a stroll through its neon-lit streets.

DAY 2: TOKYO FULL-DAY TOUR

Discover the contrasts of Tokyo with your guide today. Take part in a taiko drumming lesson, enjoy sweeping views from Tokyo Skytree, visit the historic Asakusa Kannon Temple and Nakamise Shopping Arcade, and stroll through the buzzing Akihabara district. This is a wonderful introduction to both the city's traditions and its futuristic side.

DAY 3: TOKYO CULINARY AND CULTURAL TOUR

Begin at Tsukiji Outer Market before joining a sushi-making class. Visit the peaceful Meiji Jingu Shrine and experience the vibrant fashions and youth culture of Harajuku. Along the way, enjoy a true taste of Tokyo's culinary and cultural variety.

DAY 4: TOKYO TO HIROSHIMA

Transfer to Tokyo Station with an assistant and board the Shinkansen to Hiroshima. On arrival, an assistant will walk you to your hotel. Spend the evening at leisure, perhaps sampling Hiroshima's famous okonomiyaki.

DAY 5: DAY TRIP TO HIROSHIMA AND MIYAJIMA

Visit the Peace Memorial Park, A-Bomb Dome, and Peace Memorial Museum with your guide. Continue to Miyajima by ferry to see the iconic Itsukushima Shrine before returning to Hiroshima in the evening. This moving and memorable day highlights both Japan's history and natural beauty.

DAY 6: HIROSHIMA TO OSAKA VIA HIMEJI

Travel by Shinkansen to Himeji. With your guide, explore Himeji Castle, Kokoen Garden, and either the City Museum of Literature or Nadagiku Sake Brewery. After the sightseeing concludes, continue together by train to Osaka, where your guide will escort you to your hotel. Arrive in the city known as the nation's "kitchen," where food culture thrives.

DAY 7: HALF-DAY TOUR OF OSAKA

Enjoy a guided visit to Osaka Castle, the Umeda Sky Building's Floating Garden Observatory, and the lively Dotonbori and Shinsaibashi districts. The afternoon is free to shop, relax, or continue tasting Osaka's street food specialties.

DAY 8: FULL-DAY TOUR OF KYOTO WITH EVENING PERFORMANCE

Travel by private car to Kyoto. Visit Kinkakuji (the Golden Pavilion), Nishiki Market, Nijo Castle, and Kiyomizu Temple before strolling through the geisha district of Gion. End the day with a cultural performance at Gion Corner, a highlight of any Kyoto stay.

DAY 9: KYOTO AND NARA TOUR

Visit Fushimi Inari Shrine, a sake brewery, and continue to Nara to see Todaiji Temple, Nara Deer Park, and Kasuga Taisha Shrine. Experience the charm of Japan's ancient capitals in a single day.

DAY 10: KYOTO TO TAKAYAMA

Your main luggage will be sent ahead to Takayama by courier service, so be sure to pack an overnight bag for your stay in Takayama. Today, travel via Nagoya to Takayama with assistance for your transfers along the way. Upon arrival, check in to your hotel and soak up the slower pace and old-world charm of this traditional mountain town.

DAY 11: FULL-DAY TOUR OF TAKAYAMA

Spend the day exploring the highlights of this historic town. Visit the lively Morning Market, the well-preserved Takayama Jinya, the Festival Floats Exhibition Hall, and the Kusakabe Folk Museum. Stroll along the atmospheric Sannomachi Street, lined with centuries-old wooden buildings, shops, and sake breweries.

DAY 12: TAKAYAMA TO KANAZAWA VIA SHIRAKAWAGO

Meet your English-speaking guide at 08:30 in the lobby of your hotel and depart by private car for a full day exploring Japan's picturesque mountain villages. Travel to the UNESCO-listed village of Shirakawago, where you'll take in sweeping countryside views from the Ogimachi Castle Ruins Observatory and step inside the historic Wada House to learn about traditional gassho-zukuri architecture and rural life. Continue onward to Gokayama to visit the preserved Nagase House and gain further insight into the region's heritage. Here, you will also enjoy a hands-on paper-making experience at Washi-no-sato or a similar workshop, discovering the craftsmanship behind this centuries-old tradition.

DAY 13: FULL-DAY TOUR OF KANAZAWA

Today, discover Kanazawa Castle, Kenrokuen Garden, Nomura Samurai House, and Higashi-Chaya Street with your guide. This elegant city blends history, gardens, and artistry in every corner, offering a glimpse into Japan's feudal past alongside a thriving tradition of crafts and culture.

DAY 14: KANAZAWA TO NAGANO

Transfer to Kanazawa Station with an assistant and board the train to Nagano. Continue to your hotel by public transport and enjoy the evening at leisure.

DAY 15: SNOW MONKEY TOUR

Travel with your guide to Jigokudani Monkey Park, where Japanese macaques, known as snow monkeys, gather to soak in the steaming natural hot springs. Stroll along the forested trail leading to the park and enjoy the tranquil mountain scenery as you approach. Spend time watching the monkeys in their unique habitat before returning to Nagano in the evening.

DAY 16: NAGANO TO HAKONE

This morning, meet your assistant in the lobby of your hotel and transfer together by public transport to Nagano Station. Your assistant will ensure a smooth boarding process for your reserved Green Car Shinkansen service to Tokyo. Upon arrival at Tokyo Station, another assistant will meet you on the platform and guide you through the busy station to your connecting Shinkansen to Odawara. Continue on the high-speed Hikari service before meeting your assistant once again at Odawara Station. From here, transfer by private car to your Hakone hotel, where your luggage will be stored on board and your room will be ready for check-in from the regular afternoon time.

DAY 17: FULL-DAY TOUR OF MT. FUJI AND HAKONE, TRANSFER TO TOKYO

Meet your private guide at the hotel this morning and set out by car for a full-day tour of Mount Fuji and Hakone. Visit the iconic Mount Fuji 5th Station (or the highest accessible point if weather prevents access) and enjoy sweeping views of Japan's most famous peak. Cruise across the serene waters of Lake Ashi before ascending on the Komagatake or Hakone Ropeway for even more spectacular vistas. Continue to the Hakone Open Air Museum, where striking sculptures are set against a stunning natural backdrop. After a full day of exploration, transfer by private car with your guide to Tokyo, where you will arrive in the evening and check in at your hotel. Your baggage will be stored in the car during the day for your convenience.

DAY 18: YOUR JOURNEY ENDS IN TOKYO

Transfer by private car to Narita Airport for your departure flight. If you'd like to extend your trip elsewhere in Japan or beyond, Railbookers can help tailor your journey.

TRIP HIGHLIGHTS



Discover the vibrant contrasts of Tokyo, from ancient shrines and bustling markets to futuristic districts



Visit Hiroshima's Peace Memorial Park and take a ferry to Miyajima to see the iconic "floating" torii gate



Panoramic views of Mt. Fuji, cruise on Lake Ashi, and ride ropeways in scenic Hakone

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Rail, Hotels, Sightseeing, Transfers, and More

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